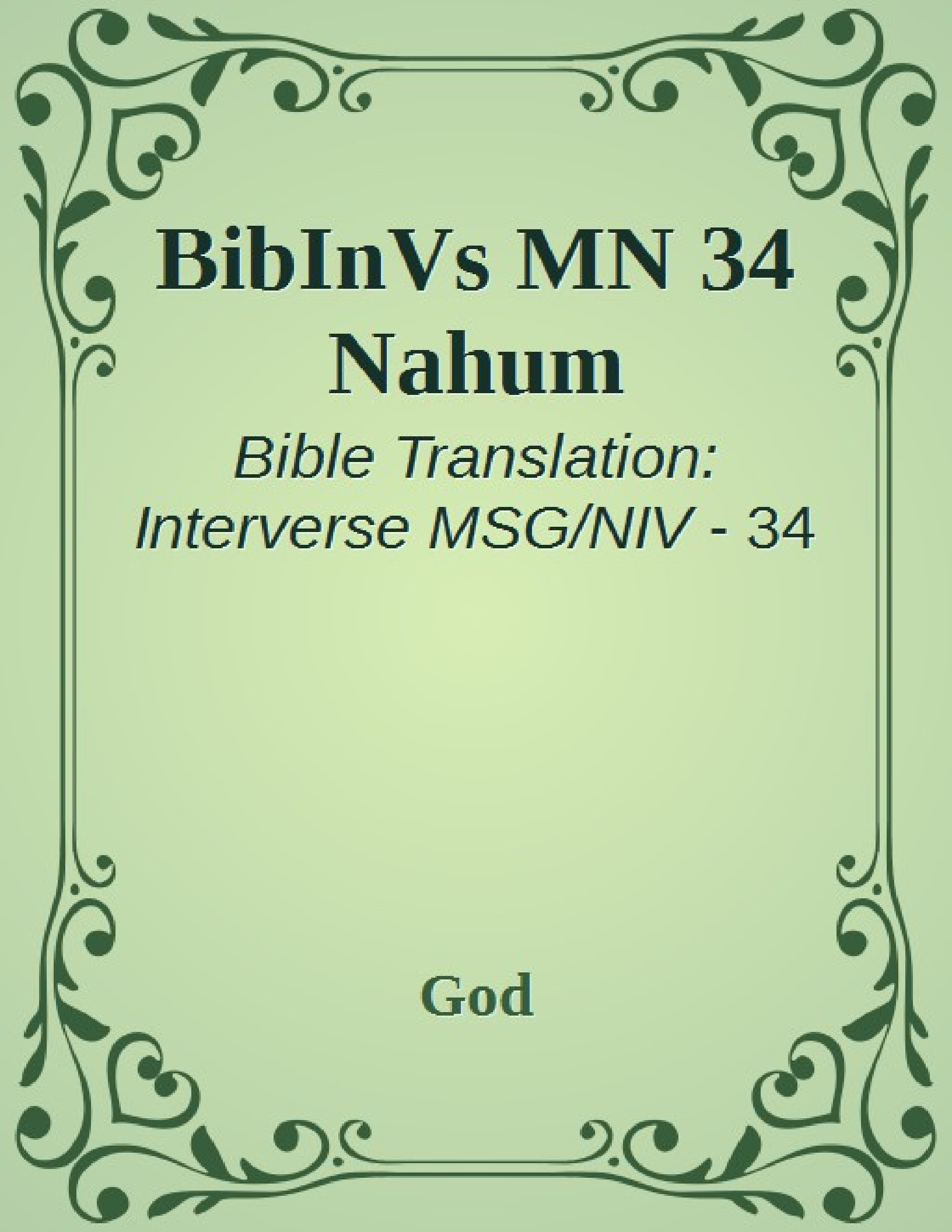


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns, rendered in a dark green color, framing the entire page.

**BibInVs MN 34**

**Nahum**

*Bible Translation:*  
*Interverse MSG/NIV - 34*

**God**

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# Interversed Message/NIV Bible

## Nahum

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### **Nahum 1**

MSG

NIV

- 1 A report on the problem of Nineveh, the way God gave Nahum of Elkosh to see it:
- 1 An oracle concerning Nineveh. The book of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite.
- 2 GOD is serious business. He won't be trifled with. He avenges his foes. He stands up against his enemies, fierce and raging.
- 2 The LORD is a jealous and avenging God; the LORD takes vengeance and is filled with wrath. The LORD takes vengeance on his foes and maintains his wrath against his enemies.
- 3 But GOD doesn't lose his temper. He's powerful, but it's a patient power. Still, no one gets by with anything. Sooner or later, everyone pays. Tornadoes and hurricanes are the wake of his passage, Storm clouds are the dust he shakes off his feet.
- 3 The LORD is slow to anger and great in power; the LORD will not leave the guilty unpunished. His way is in the whirlwind and the storm, and clouds are the dust of his feet.
- 4 He yells at the sea: It dries up. All the rivers run dry. The Bashan and Carmel mountains shrivel, the Lebanon orchards shrivel.
- 4 He rebukes the sea and dries it up; he makes all the rivers run dry. Bashan and Carmel wither and the blossoms of Lebanon fade.
- 5 Mountains quake in their roots, hills dissolve into mud flats. Earth shakes in fear of GOD. The whole world's in a panic.
- 5 The mountains quake before him and the hills melt away. The earth trembles at his presence, the world and all who live in it.
- 6 Who can face such towering anger? Who can stand up to this fierce rage? His anger spills out like a river of lava, his fury shatters boulders.

- 6 Who can withstand his indignation? Who can endure his fierce anger?  
His wrath is poured out like fire; the rocks are shattered before him.
- 7 GOD is good, a hiding place in tough times. He recognizes and  
welcomes anyone looking for help,
- 7 The LORD is good, a refuge in times of trouble. He cares for those who  
trust in him,
- 8 No matter how desperate the trouble. But cozy islands of escape He  
wipes right off the map. No one gets away from God.
- 8 but with an overwhelming flood he will make an end of Nineveh; he will  
pursue his foes into darkness.
- 9 Why waste time conniving against GOD? He's putting an end to all such  
scheming. For troublemakers, no second chances.
- 9 Whatever they plot against the LORD he will bring to an end; trouble  
will not come a second time.
- 10 Like a pile of dry brush, Soaked in oil, they'll go up in flames.
- 10 They will be entangled among thorns and drunk from their wine; they  
will be consumed like dry stubble.
- 11 Nineveh's an anthill of evil plots against GOD, A think tank for lies that  
seduce and betray.
- 11 From you, O Nineveh, has one come forth who plots evil against the  
LORD and counsels wickedness.
- 12 And GOD has something to say about all this: "Even though you're on  
top of the world, With all the applause and all the votes, you'll be mowed  
down flat. "I've afflicted you, Judah, true, but I won't afflict you again.
- 12 This is what the LORD says: "Although they have allies and are  
numerous, they will be cut off and pass away. Although I have afflicted  
you, O Judah, I will afflict you no more.
- 13 From now on I'm taking the yoke from your neck and splitting it up for  
kindling. I'm cutting you free from the ropes of your bondage."
- 13 Now I will break their yoke from your neck and tear your shackles  
away."
- 14 GOD's orders on Nineveh: "You're the end of the line. It's all over with  
Nineveh. I'm gutting your temple. Your gods and goddesses go in the  
trash. I'm digging your grave. It's an unmarked grave. You're nothing--  
no, you're less than nothing!"

- 14 The LORD has given a command concerning you, Nineveh: "You will have no descendants to bear your name. I will destroy the carved images and cast idols that are in the temple of your gods. I will prepare your grave, for you are vile."
- 15 Look! Striding across the mountains-- a messenger bringing the latest good news: peace! A holiday, Judah! Celebrate! Worship and recommit to God! No more worries about this enemy. This one is history. Close the books.
- 15 Look, there on the mountains, the feet of one who brings good news, who proclaims peace! Celebrate your festivals, O Judah, and fulfill your vows. No more will the wicked invade you; they will be completely destroyed.

## **Nahum 2**

MSG

NIV

- 1 The juggernaut's coming! Post guards, lay in supplies. Get yourselves together, get ready for the big battle.
- 1 An attacker advances against you, Nineveh. Guard the fortress, watch the road, brace yourselves, marshal all your strength!
- 2 GOD has restored the Pride of Jacob, the Pride of Israel. Israel's lived through hard times. He's been to hell and back.
- 2 The LORD will restore the splendor of Jacob like the splendor of Israel, though destroyers have laid them waste and have ruined their vines.
- 3 Weapons flash in the sun, the soldiers splendid in battle dress, Chariots burnished and glistening, ready to charge, A spiked forest of brandished spears, lethal on the horizon.
- 3 The shields of his soldiers are red; the warriors are clad in scarlet. The metal on the chariots flashes on the day they are made ready; the spears of pine are brandished.
- 4 The chariots pour into the streets. They fill the public squares, Flaming like torches in the sun, like lightning darting and flashing.
- 4 The chariots storm through the streets, rushing back and forth through the squares. They look like flaming torches; they dart about like lightning.

- 5 The Assyrian king rallies his men, but they stagger and stumble. They run to the ramparts to stem the tide, but it's too late.
- 5 He summons his picked troops, yet they stumble on their way. They dash to the city wall; the protective shield is put in place.
- 6 Soldiers pour through the gates. The palace is demolished.
- 6 The river gates are thrown open and the palace collapses.
- 7 Soon it's all over: Nineveh stripped, Nineveh doomed, Maids and slaves moaning like doves, beating their breasts.
- 7 It is decreed that the city be exiled and carried away. Its slave girls moan like doves and beat upon their breasts.
- 8 Nineveh is a tub from which they've pulled the plug. Cries go up, "Do something! Do something!" but it's too late. Nineveh's soon empty--nothing.
- 8 Nineveh is like a pool, and its water is draining away. "Stop! Stop!" they cry, but no one turns back.
- 9 Other cries come: "Plunder the silver! Plunder the gold! A bonanza of plunder! Take everything you want!"
- 9 Plunder the silver! Plunder the gold! The supply is endless, the wealth from all its treasures!
- 10 Doom! Damnation! Desolation! Hearts sink, knees fold, stomachs retch, faces blanch.
- 10 She is pillaged, plundered, stripped! Hearts melt, knees give way, bodies tremble, every face grows pale.
- 11 So, what happened to the famous and fierce Assyrian lion And all those cute Assyrian cubs? To the lion and lioness Cozy with their cubs, fierce and fearless?
- 11 Where now is the lions' den, the place where they fed their young, where the lion and lioness went, and the cubs, with nothing to fear?
- 12 To the lion who always returned from the hunt with fresh kills for lioness and cubs, The lion lair heaped with bloody meat, blood and bones for the royal lion feast?
- 12 The lion killed enough for his cubs and strangled the prey for his mate, filling his lairs with the kill and his dens with the prey.
- 13 "Assyria, I'm your enemy," says GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies. "I'll torch your chariots. They'll go up in smoke. 'Lion Country' will be strewn with carcasses. The war business is over--you're out of work: You'll have no

more wars to report, No more victories to announce. You're out of war work forever."

- 13 I am against you, declares the LORD Almighty. "I will burn up your chariots in smoke, and the sword will devour your young lions. I will leave you no prey on the earth. The voices of your messengers will no longer be heard."

## **Nahum 3**

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to Murder City-- full of lies, bursting with loot, addicted to violence!
- 1 Woe to the city of blood, full of lies, full of plunder, never without victims!
- 2 Horns blaring, wheels clattering, horses rearing, chariots lurching,
- 2 The crack of whips, the clatter of wheels, galloping horses and jolting chariots!
- 3 Horsemen galloping, brandishing swords and spears, Dead bodies rotting in the street, corpses stacked like cordwood, Bodies in every gutter and alley, clogging every intersection!
- 3 Charging cavalry, flashing swords and glittering spears! Many casualties, piles of dead, bodies without number, people stumbling over the corpses--
- 4 And whores! Whores without end! Whore City, Fatally seductive, you're the Witch of Seduction, luring nations to their ruin with your evil spells.
- 4 all because of the wanton lust of a harlot, alluring, the mistress of sorceries, who enslaved nations by her prostitution and peoples by her witchcraft.
- 5 "I'm your enemy, Whore Nineveh-- I, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies! I'll strip you of your seductive silk robes and expose you on the world stage. I'll let the nations get their fill of the ugly truth of who you really are and have been all along.
- 5 I am against you, declares the LORD Almighty. "I will lift your skirts over your face. I will show the nations your nakedness and the kingdoms your shame.

- 6 I'll pelt you with dog dung and place you on a pedestal: 'Slut on Exhibit.'
- 6 I will pelt you with filth, I will treat you with contempt and make you a spectacle.
- 7 Everyone who sees you will gag and say, 'Nineveh's a pigsty: What on earth did we ever see in her? Who would give her a second look? Ugh!'"
- 7 All who see you will flee from you and say, 'Nineveh is in ruins--who will mourn for her?' Where can I find anyone to comfort you?"
- 8 Do you think you're superior to Egyptian Thebes, proudly invincible on the River Nile, Protected by the great River, walled in by the River, secure?
- 8 Are you better than Thebes, situated on the Nile, with water around her? The river was her defense, the waters her wall.
- 9 Ethiopia stood guard to the south, Egypt to the north. Put and Libya, strong friends, were ready to step in and help.
- 9 Cush and Egypt were her boundless strength; Put and Libya were among her allies.
- 10 But you know what happened to her: The whole city was marched off to a refugee camp, Her babies smashed to death in public view on the streets, Her prize leaders auctioned off, her celebrities put in chain gangs.
- 10 Yet she was taken captive and went into exile. Her infants were dashed to pieces at the head of every street. Lots were cast for her nobles, and all her great men were put in chains.
- 11 Expect the same treatment, Nineveh. You'll soon be staggering like a bunch of drunks, Wondering what hit you, looking for a place to sleep it off.
- 11 You too will become drunk; you will go into hiding and seek refuge from the enemy.
- 12 All your forts are like peach trees, the lush peaches ripe, ready for the picking. One shake of the tree and they fall straight into hungry mouths.
- 12 All your fortresses are like fig trees with their first ripe fruit; when they are shaken, the figs fall into the mouth of the eater.
- 13 Face it: Your warriors are wimps. You're sitting ducks. Your borders are gaping doors, inviting your enemies in. And who's to stop them?
- 13 Look at your troops-- they are all women! The gates of your land are wide open to your enemies; fire has consumed their bars.



- 14 Store up water for the siege. Shore up your defenses. Get down to basics: Work the clay and make bricks.
- 14 Draw water for the siege, strengthen your defenses! Work the clay, tread the mortar, repair the brickwork!
- 15 Sorry. Too late. Enemy fire will burn you up. Swords will cut you to pieces. You'll be chewed up as if by locusts. Yes, as if by locusts--a fitting fate, for you yourselves are a locust plague.
- 15 There the fire will devour you; the sword will cut you down and, like grasshoppers, consume you. Multiply like grasshoppers, multiply like locusts!
- 16 You've multiplied shops and shopkeepers-- more buyers and sellers than stars in the sky! A plague of locusts, cleaning out the neighborhood and then flying off.
- 16 You have increased the number of your merchants till they are more than the stars of the sky, but like locusts they strip the land and then fly away.
- 17 Your bureaucrats are locusts, your brokers and bankers are locusts. Early on, they're all at your service, full of smiles and promises, But later when you return with questions or complaints, you'll find they've flown off and are nowhere to be found.
- 17 Your guards are like locusts, your officials like swarms of locusts that settle in the walls on a cold day-- but when the sun appears they fly away, and no one knows where.
- 18 King of Assyria! Your shepherd-leaders, in charge of caring for your people, Are busy doing everything else but. They're not doing their job, And your people are scattered and lost. There's no one to look after them.
- 18 O king of Assyria, your shepherds slumber; your nobles lie down to rest. Your people are scattered on the mountains with no one to gather them.
- 19 You're past the point of no return. Your wound is fatal. When the story of your fate gets out, the whole world will applaud and cry "Encore!" Your cruel evil has seeped into every nook and cranny of the world. Everyone has felt it and suffered.
- 19 Nothing can heal your wound; your injury is fatal. Everyone who hears the news about you claps his hands at your fall, for who has not felt your

endless cruelty?